

September, 2022

HELPERS DIGEST

EDUCATION - HEALTH - GOVERNANCE - GENDER - SOCIAL ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT - AGRICULTURE

CHAMPION OF CHANGE SUCCESS STORIES



MAS'UD ISAH BALLA'S INSPIRING TRANSFORMATION

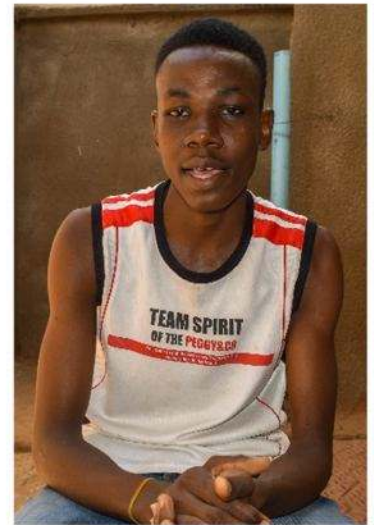
Mas'ud Isa Balla, a 21-year-old from Bondinga Local Government in Sokoto, faced a challenging period after graduating from Bondinga Government School in 2018. Despite concerted efforts, he struggled to secure admission into any institution, leading to a sense of depression signs such as; Insomnia, social deficit/ loneliness. As the holidays rolled around and peers pursued their academic or vocational paths, Mas'ud withdrew further, avoiding communication and confining himself indoors.

In 2023, a ray of hope entered Mas'ud life with the arrival of interpersonal therapy for group (IPT-G) a project by Plan International in partnership with Life Helpers. Considering his situation, he was introduced to the group by their facilitator Fahad, after administering PHQ2&9 with a score of 12. At the beginning he was resisting all forms of help but found solace and started opening during his middle phase. Experiencing a newfound sense of peace and comfort through

singing and dancing. This marked his turning point.

Mas'ud transformed from an angry and disengaged individual to a happy, proactive one. His positive shift extended to the workplace, where he interacted with customers, eagerly learned new designs, and improved sewing skills. The facilitator testified. Mas'ud is thankful for the initiati-

ve and advised youth facing depression in his word: "Duk abin da aka ce ya kamata maki, ko kasance mai laushi,"



“
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”

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MAS'UD ISAH BALLA'S INSPIRING TRANSFORMATION



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Mas'ud journey from isolation to active participation, happiness, and improved skills is a testament to the transformative impact of community programs. His story serves as an inspiration, highlighting the importance of support systems in overcoming challenges and finding one's path to personal and professional fulfillment in our community the aunty testified with gratitude Plan International.

BABANGIDA ALHAJI'S INSPIRING JOURNEY FROM ADVERSITY TO EMPOWERMENT

Babangida, a resilient young man from the family of nine, faced significant challenges when he lost his father while studying in his first year at the School of Health in Sokoto (grave). His mother, a widow and a homemaker, struggled to provide for the family. The financial strain forced Babangida and his siblings into farming, causing interruptions in his education as they waited for harvests to sell their products to meet their financial needs.

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By the second year, Babangida managed to pay his school fees, but his mother, foreseeing ongoing difficulties, advised him to drop out. This decision plunged him into a deep depres-

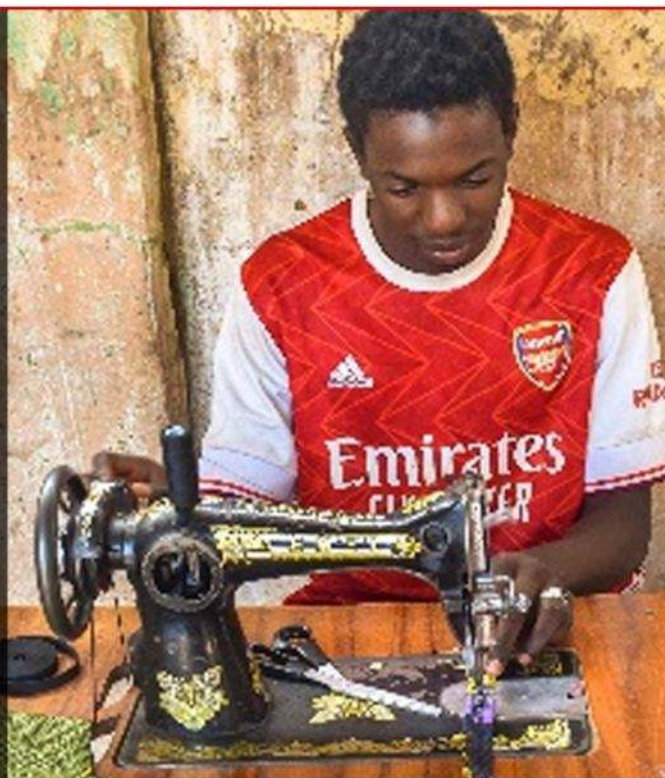
BABANGIDA ALHAJI'S INSPIRING JOURNEY FROM ADVERSITY TO EMPOWERMENT

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sion. Isolation became his coping mechanism as former friends mocked him, excluding him from social gatherings. Nights were spent in tears, and he contemplated various ways to generate income.

His life took a turn when he encountered a friend who referred him to join the IPT-G where he was pre-assessed by the facilitator and enrolled. Initially skeptical, Babangida attended a few sessions, expressing his wonder said *"Mei neman wannan karamar hira? Saboda ba komai nake duba a nan. Aikuwa, wani abu ne."* However, with each visit, he found solace and looked forward to the group activities, especially the energizing sessions, suggestions of group members on issues. Fahad a facilitator in the group, noticed Babangida's quiet behavior and took the initiative to learn about his story. After a visit to Babangida's home, Fahad discovered the challenges he faced. Abu's transformation began when he volunteered to lead the group, marking a fundamental moment in his life.

Inspired by the group's impact, Babangida also learned how to sew, a skill he attributes to the group's influence. Grateful for the support from Plan International and the LHI team, Babangida is



now planning to return to school. He visualizes opening a similar group with his friends to help other children facing depression, emphasizing the importance of sharing problems and persevering.

In Hausa, Babangida advises, *"Duk abin da ya kamata a kara bayyana, kuma kada ka yi hakuri. A lokacin daidai, abubuwan za su yi aiki."* His personal health quotient (PHQ) has remarkably improved, showcasing his active participation and positive transformation. His facilitator testified.

Babangida's story from Bondiga LGA, Sokoto, Toma ward, is a testament to resilience, community support, and the transformative power of education and mentorship.

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HALIMA'S RESILIENCE, A JOURNEY FROM DARKNESS TO LIGHT



Halima's family learned about the IPT- group. Bringing her to join the group marked a hopeful chapter in her life. She took the PHQ 2. Initially unresponsive during the first and second visits, Halima's silence spoke volumes about her internal struggles. It took a one-on-one counselling with the facilitator to unlock her emotions.

Halima, a 19-year-old secondary school student and the sixth child among 18 siblings, faced a tumultuous period when her parents, residing in Zamfara, decided to send her to Sokoto State due to financial constraints and escalating insecurity in their home state. In 2022, as the menace of kidnapping plagued Zamfara, communication lines were severed, plunging Halima's family into anxiety.

Stranded in Sokoto under the care of her uncle in Magajin Gari Ward, Sokoto South LGA, Halima succumbed to the weight of her circumstances. The life change and dissolution led to depression, causing her academic performance to drop from a B student to an alarming low. Despite the best efforts of her teachers, Halima withdrew from her studies, becoming detached and lost in deep contemplation. Tears replaced laughter, and her emotional state became a cause for concern for her uncle.

The turning point arrived when

Halima revealed that, with the support of the group mentor and her uncle, her parents were persuaded to move back to Sokoto. Reunited with her family, Halima underwent a remarkable transformation. Her renewed sense of happiness and engagement reflected positively in her academic endeavors. Her teachers, comparing her current state with her previous results, acknowledged a significant improvement. Inspired to become a doctor in the future, Halima expressed deep gratitude to the Plan International and Life Helpers.

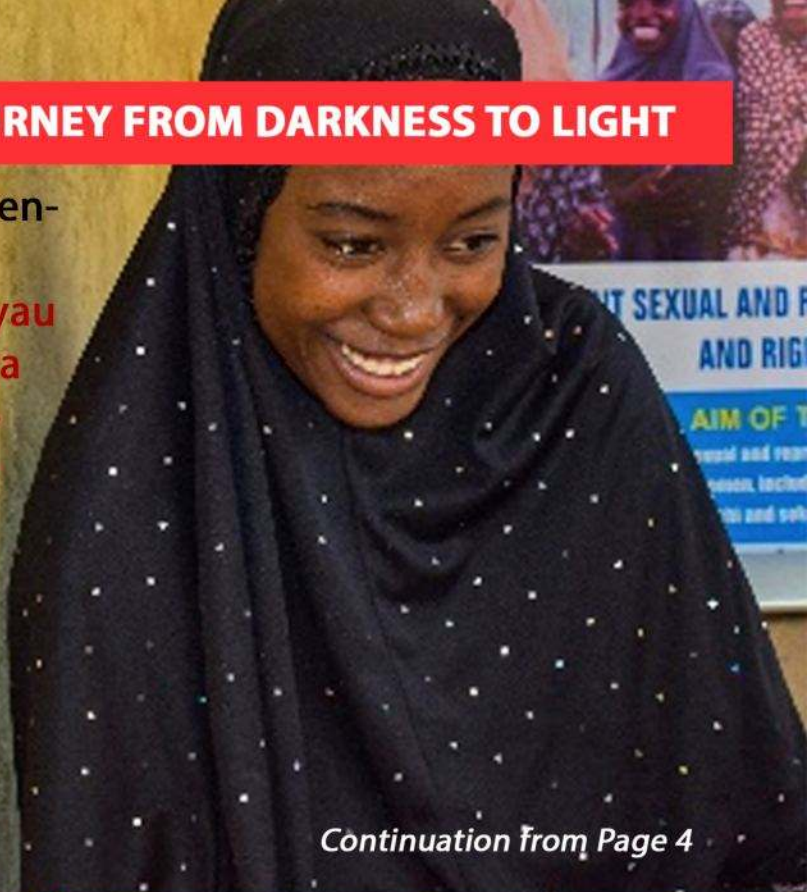
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HALIMA'S RESILIENCE, A JOURNEY FROM DARKNESS TO LIGHT

In offering advice to adolescents enduring similar pain, Halima said; "Ina so ka yi rayuwa! Kada ka yi kyau a damuwa da matsalar da baka iya tattare da ita. Yi kasance mai gas-kiya, ba'ayi amfani da mutane da suke cikin zuciyarka domin tai-maka maka."

At her termination staged she stands as a testament to the transformative power of community programs in restoring hope and rebuilding lives.



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HADIZA'S TRIUMPH OVER TRIALS



"An yi ni nasara, ka iya yi." Hadiza said ; Hadiza, is a young girl from Zamfara State, Dinya Uku, faced challenges beyond her years. Sent to Sokoto due to insecurity, her life took an unexpected turn when her grandfather, who had saved for her wedding, was kidnapped. Fearing for her mother's health, she bore this burden silently, abandoning school and isolating herself at home. That led to life change.

Introduced to the IPT-group by a neighbor, Hadiza took the PHQ 2 test, was enrolled yet found solace in silent tears during meetings. A one-on-one counselling section unveiled her hidden struggles, including the family's inability to pay a 2-million-naira ransom. With guidance from her facilitators and elders, the family sold properties, securing her grandfather's release.

Grateful to the program and its sponsors, Hadiza learned the art of hair plating, recognizing its potential as a source of income. Motivated by her peers in the group, she resumed schooling, discarding marriage plans. Inspired by her peers' aspirations, Hadiza now dreams of becoming a lawyer or teacher.

HADIZA'S TRIUMPH OVER TRIALS

In her own words, "**Duk abin da ka yi na Plan da Life Helpers, na gode.**" Hadiza's story embodies resilience, community support, and the transformative power of programs like the IPT - Group, paving the way for a brighter future." I have seen a sad looking young lady turn into a joyful active and skillful young lady" her facilitator said during the interview.

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BREAKING CHAINS, ABUBAKAR ALIYU'S TRANSFORMATION



Abubakar Aliyu, the second child in a family of four, faced a challenging upbringing. Growing up in Sokoto South Local Government, Magajin Gari ward, he navigated life from a young age, often fending for himself from neighborhood waste bins. Raised by a widowed mother working tirelessly as a cleaner for 17 years, Abubakar's struggles persisted, as his grief daily.

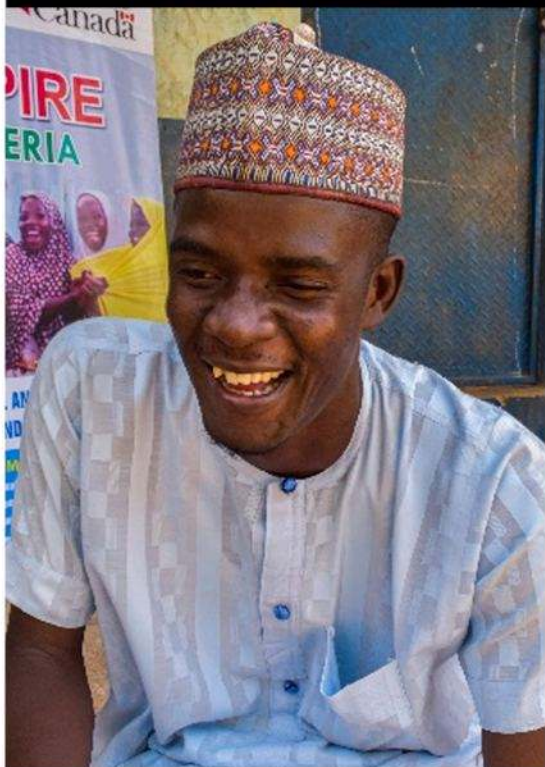
Despite his early hardships, Abubakar graduated from the College of Education, Sokoto state, at the age of 25. His journey took a dark turn during his senior secondary

Disillusioned by broken promises, he found himself at a point of deep despair, contemplating desperate measures for survival.

The turning point came when he learned about the IPT-group through his facilitator. He took the PHQ test with high score due to his condition. Desperate for change, he joined the group and discovered a newfound sense of love, care, and attention that had eluded him for 25 years. Interacting with others, he returned home, assisting people with errands to provide for their needs. This experience brought him a joy he had never known.

In his words, Abubakar advises boys facing similar struggles: "Ka-dang-kadang kake bukatar sauran damuwa domin canza kai da aiki da sauran mutane su taimaka maki a cikin jere. Kada ka jin hankali da canzawa maki aiki saboda duk abin da za ka yi zai taimaka maka."

BREAKING CHAINS, ABUBAKAR ALIYU'S TRANSFORMATION



Abubakar expresses gratitude to Plan International and the Life Helpers team for their support. He appeals for assistance in securing a job to continue his journey towards becoming a better version of himself. To his facilitator, he appreciates the efforts made, especially in providing food, financial aid, and clothing. Abubakar's story is one of breaking free from chains, finding hope, and aspiring to build a brighter future an elder met at his neighborhood testified. He added by saying Abubakar has changed and that has alone is a big miracle.



Tayo Fatinikun
Joy Dauda Dogo
Oluwafemi Tanimowo
Adetola Olabode
Tade Adeogo
Nosa Ojo



LIFE HELPERS INITIATIVE

Putting a smile on a face

OUR MISSION

Be a leading non-governmental organisation working to maximise all opportunities to empower the marginalized people.

OUR VISION

A more Fulfilled Life for Everyone

OUR VALUES

- Love -** Friendly Atmosphere; Kind Gestures; Togetherness
- HONESTLY -** Openness; Forthright, Matching our words with our actions.
- INCLUSION -** Access to all; Acceptance; Opportunity for staff & clients



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